ROPE D&D 2024 – DESCRIPTION

Climbing or descending a rope is **special movement**. In 2024, climbing **doubles movement cost**, and the DM may call for a **Strength (Athletics)** check if the surface is slippery or has few handholds. The **rope-specific DCs** are table rules (homebrew).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Each foot climbed costs **double**: climbing speed is **half** your Speed (30 feet gives **15 feet** per turn).
2. A **Climb Speed** removes this extra cost.
3. The DM asks for a **Strength (Athletics)** check. A **Dexterity (Acrobatics)** check remains possible in special cases.
4. Official: **DC 15** for a slippery surface or one with few handholds. Table: **plain rope DC 10**, **knotted rope DC 5**.
5. Factors **raise** or **lower** the DC (page 2).

⚠ What is official (2024):

- **Climbing:** every foot moved costs double movement (triple in Difficult Terrain).
- **Climb Speed:** it replaces Speed, with no extra cost.
- **DC 15:** at the DM's discretion, for a slippery surface or one with few handholds.

⚠ What is a table rule (homebrew):

- The **rope DCs** (plain, knotted).
- The **modifiers**: weather, wet rope, gear, heavy armor.
- The **climbing time table**.

⚠ Change from 2014

The cost stays the same (each foot costs one extra). The 2024 text adds a **DC 15** for a slippery surface or one with few handholds, where 2014 gave no DC.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes

No official DC for a **rope**, and nothing about the **consequences of a failure**. Fix: the DM announces the **table DCs** before the game and what a failure costs (no progress, a slip, a fall).

💡 Narrative option:

The DM can describe the **creaking rope**, the **rough fibers** burning the palms, and the **drop** opening below.

Step 1 – Move on the rope:

Each foot climbed or descended costs **double** movement. With the **Dash** action, you gain extra movement equal to your Speed.

Example: 30-foot Speed, 15 feet climbed per turn. With Dash, 30 feet.

Step 2 – Choose the check:

The DM asks for a **Strength** (**Athletics**) check. They may allow **Dexterity** (**Acrobatics**) in a special situation.

Step 3 – Set the DC:

Situation	DC
Knotted rope (many knots)	**5**
Plain rope, fair conditions	**10**
Slippery surface or few handholds (official)	**15**
Several unfavorable factors combined	**15 or more**

Step 4 – Adjust the DC (homebrew):

- **Raises it by +2 to +5:** wet or slippery rope, strong wind, rain, storm, frost, poor visibility, no gear.
- **Lowers it by 2 to 5:** climbing gear (harness, pitons, belt).
- **Advantage:** an ally takes the **Help** action to guide the climb or hold the rope.
- **Heavy armor:** the DM may impose **Disadvantage**.

Example: Brann (Athletics +5) climbs a knotted rope in the rain: DC 5 + 3 = 8. He rolls 12 + 5 = 17: success.

Step 5 – Count the time (30-foot Speed):

Distance	Time needed
15 feet	1 turn
30 feet	2 turns
50 feet	4 turns
75 feet	5 turns

ROPE D&D 2024 – Q&A

Answers based on the 2024 glossary and on the table rules.

Do I need a check to climb a rope?

Not always: climbing simply costs double movement. The DM may call for a **Strength (Athletics) DC 15** check if the surface is slippery or has few handholds.

Is descending different from climbing up?

No: **climbing** covers both, with the same costs and checks.

What about a Climb Speed?

You climb **with no extra cost**: you use your Climb Speed instead of your Speed.

Can I climb faster?

Yes, with the **Dash** action: you gain movement equal to your Speed. With 30 feet, you climb **30 feet** in the turn.

How long does 50 feet take?

At 15 feet per turn, **4 turns** (3.3 rounded up).

Can an ally help?

Yes, with the **Help** action: they give **Advantage** on the next ability check with the chosen skill (Athletics).

What happens on a failure?

The text doesn't say: the DM decides (no progress, a slip, a fall). A fall deals 1d6 bludgeoning damage per 10 feet.

Does heavy armor hinder climbing?

Not according to the 2024 text. It is a table rule: possible **Disadvantage**, at the DM's choice.